

videos when watching movies and other data.

3.1.5 WHY IT SUCKS

UMD – without a doubt, the greatest failing of the PlayStation Portable is the Universal Media Drive. The format was a complete disaster and caused more trouble than good.

More importantly, the size of the UMD and its disk-like handling makes it very difficult to carry around. With the DS cartridges, you can freely hold them from both sides like a video cassette, without risk of damaging the data. On a UMD, however, the handling is similar to that of a CD or DVD – a clumsy and difficult proposition at that size.

Fragility – if there is one aspect in the entire hardware of the PSP and the DS where the latter scores, it is in the sturdiness of the device.

Even with the slightest of mishandling, the PSP is prone to get scratches on its screen and body. The glossy finish also tends to make it difficult to grasp at times, and the device can become completely in-operational with a severe fall.

The need to handle the device with kids' gloves and the added weight of a sturdy case makes the PSP a bulky and high-maintenance proposition in the long run.

3.2 Nintendo DS

With Sony coming out with a new handheld video game console, the grandpas of the portable gaming world were not going to sit back and watch. Nintendo's GameBoy had ruled the genre for the past decade and the company had no intention of handing over the mantle.

But word had already got out about how the PlayStation Portable was going to be a behemoth in terms of hardware, with a large screen to boot. Sony wanted to bring serious gaming to the handheld world, while Nintendo's strong point has always been about 'fun' games that appeal to people across several age groups.

It is difficult to hit a middle ground where developers are free to unleash their creativity in coming out with new games while making the platform approachable for the consumer without making him have to learn a lot of new things. But if there was one company that could do it, it was Nintendo.

President Satoru Iwata said: "We have developed Nintendo DS based upon a completely

